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Peking June 10[12]

Mr. Lowder's

No. 99

10 Enclosures

—o—

Rec'd Aug: 22

—o—

Japanese Expedition to Formosa. further on

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Peking
10 June 1874

No 99

My Lord,

In continuation of my Despatch No: 72 of the 30 April, regarding the Japanese expedition to Formosa, I have the honor to forward copies of some correspondence referring to Mr. Gregory's report already forwarded direct to Your Lordship and to other sources of intelligence.

I have the

Right Honorable
The Earl of Derby

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public or private, between ourself
and the Kung-li Yamên.

The expedition, it would
appear, left Nagasaki in
defiance of the order of the
Government countermanding it.
Ships belonging to or chartered by
the Japanese, touched at Amoy,
and thence proceeded to the South
end of Formosa. Two American
Officers were with the troops.
M. LeGendre had been detained
by Mr. Bingham, the United
States Minister, who had
also stopped two American

Steamers

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Steamers.

That Formosa, and such Corea, has been for some time the point to which the Expedition was directed, is shewn by the facts, of which I am credibly informed, that the Japanese had stored at Amoy some 150,000 piculs, say 10,000 tons, of rice.

Sir Charles Shadwell has been so good as to send me a map of the country invaded from which I gather that the ground the Japanese were understood to declare

independent

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independent of China, stretches from Tinan on the East Coast to Lang Kiao on the West, and the idea of the Japanese seems to have been to connect these two points by a line of forts.

The Chinese Government, as my Telegram of the 31 May will have told Your Lordship, have sent an Imperial Commissioner to Formosa. The Decree appointing him was dated 28th May, but he must have been named earlier for the news was in the Shanghai

papers

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papers before it was known here.
The Commissioner Shên Pao-ching,
by reputu an able Chinese, has
been long Superintendent of this
Arsenal at Foochow. I imagine
that he will, if necessary, amuse
the Japanese with a show of
negotiations until he is ready
to strike. In preparation for
war I expect that he will be
assisted by M. Giquel, the
very clever Officer of the French
Navy, who, as I have before
reported, has been, under
Shên, the Director of the
Foochow

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Foreign Arrival.

Mr. Gregory states that the Japanese on landing were well received by the Chinese who believed that they came as allies to protect them, the Chinese, against the Mountain or Bowtan Savages. A late telegram, which has been communicated to me, tells of a collision between the Japanese and some villagers, whether Chinese or Savages I cannot say, in which four Japanese and thirteen natives were

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were killed or wounded. From the North of the Island the news is also unfavorable to the Japanese. Their vessels go into Keelung for coal, and the crews are stated to give offence by their lawless conduct towards the women of the place.

I append copy of Sir Charles Shadwell's reply to my Despatch of the 20 April requesting him to take special care of the Formosan ports; also the Map I have above referred to.

Print

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Thanelter honorable,

My Lord,

With the highest respect,

Your Lordships most obedient

humble Servant

Thomas Francis Wade.

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Mr. Wade
to
Prince of Hsing

Enclosure
No. 1
in Mr. Wade's
No. 99
of June 10th 1874

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Semi-official

16th May 1874

Sir

Mr Wade presents his compliments to the Prince of Kung.

He the Prince will doubtless have learned from their Excellencies Mao. Shen. and Chung. Mr. Wade received, on the 14th inst, a Despatch from Sir Harry Parkes, under date the 29th April, in which were enclosed copies of a correspondence with the Japanese Secretary of State

The Prince of Kung 43

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State Terashima, regarding the proposed expedition against the Aborigines of Formosa.

Mr. Wade begs to forward H.J.H. translations of the Despatches referred to, respectively dated the 14th and 16th April.

Sir H. Parkes has since received an assurance from the Japanese Secretary of State that the Japanese Government, understanding the Government of China not to view with favor the expedition to Formosa, has stopped it.

The

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The newly appointed Japanese Minister was to leave Japan for Peking upon the same day, the 29th April. Sir H. Parkes's Despatch is dated Yedo. According to the newspapers some vessels, carrying Japanese troops, had already left Nagasaki, and, as H.J.H. cannot fail to be aware, the arrival of a force apparently en route to Formosa was telegraphed a few days since from Amoy. For the truth of these latter reports, however, Mr. Wade does not undertake to vouch.

He avails &c.

(Signed) T.F. Wade

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Copy

Mr Wade

&

Prince of Hung

Enclosure

No 2

in Mr Wade's

No 99

of June 18th 1874

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Semi-official Note

2w 24

Peking
19th May 1874

Sir

Mr. Wade presents his compliments to the Prince of Kung:

By a telegram, received this day, dated 11th inst, Sir H. Parkes informs Mr. Wade that some 6 or 7 vessels with about 2000 men have left. he does not say what port in Japan. for Formosa. They were accompanied by two foreign officers. It was understood that they would call at Amoy and communicate

The Prince of Kung 44

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communicate with the local Government.

In a letter dated 12th inst. Sir Charles Shadwell, writing from Shanghai, states that on the 25th April he received a telegram, apparently from his flag captain, to the effect that the expedition to Formosa was postponed pending negociations with China. Later the Admiral had heard that on the 27th a Japanese steamer had left Nagasaki with troops and stores for South

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South Formosa via Amoy.
On the 4th inst a telegram
from Nagasaki brought
information that two
Japanese men of war and
two steamers with 1200
men had left for Formosa.
It is not quite plain from
what port this force
proceeded; nor is it clear
in the Admiral's opinion
that its destination was
Formosa.

(Signed) J. F. Wade.

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W. Wade
to
Prince of Thurn

Enclosure
N° 3
in W. Wade's
N° 44
of June 10th 1874

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Peking.
May 22nd 1874.

M. Wade presents his compliments to the Prince of Kung.

The Prince it is presumed will have received M. Wade's notes of the 16th and 19th inst -- regarding the Japanese expedition to Formosa.

M. Wade begs to enclose a Memorandum of some further information received last evening

He avails &c.

(signed) T. F. Wade

H.

Prince of Kung
&c &c &c.

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Memorandum

Enclosure
No 4
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No 99
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memo

Peking
22nd May 1874

Sir

On the 21st April Mr Wade telegraphed to Sir H. Parkes to the effect that the Tsungli Yamen declared the country inhabited by the Aborigines of Formosa to be part of the Chinese Empire; also that the Yamen had no knowledge of the Japanese expedition against these people.

In a Despatch dated 5th May. which reached Mr. Wade on the 21st. Sir H. Parkes informs Mr Wade that the above telegram has been communicated to

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to the Government of Japan.

Sir H. Parkes also states that the Minister of Finance having been earlier sent to Nagasaki to despatch the expedition, on the 29th April another Minister was sent to recal him. On the same day, however, Sir H. Parkes received a telegram from the British Consul at Nagasaki to the effect that one vessel with troops and two foreign officers had left Nagasaki for Amoy.

Sir. H. Parkes, as the Yamen has already been informed,

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informed, had written that a Japanese Minister was to leave Japan for China on the 29th April. Sir H. Parkes now states that that information proves to be incorrect, that it is uncertain when the Minister named will leave Japan, or whether the appointment may not be given to another.

On the 21st May Mr Wade received copies of telegrams dated 15th May from the British Consul at Amoy and the officer commanding H.M.'s vessel stationed at that port, which, by desire of Sir Chas Shadwell,

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Shadwell had visited the south coast of Formosa. There announced the arrival at Liang-kiao of a ship with Japanese troops. The inhabitants were friendly, and the troops landed without opposition.

Sir Chas. Shadwell has directed a vessel of the squadron to pay frequent visits to the ports of Taiwan and Tamsui. It will also occasionally visit the south end of Formosa, in order that the Commander in Chief may be informed of what is passing.

(Signed) T. F. Wade.

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Translation

Prince Gortschakoff

to

Mr. Locke

Enclosure

No. 5

in Mr. Locke's

No. 99

of June 18/2 1874

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~~Note from~~ From the Prince of Kung and the Ministers of the Yamen ~~of Foreign Affairs to H. M's Minister~~ dup

Peking. May 22nd, 1874

The Prince and his colleagues have very great pleasure in acknowledging the receipt of Mr. Wade's successive notes with reference to the Japanese expedition to Formosa, of his friendly attention in forwarding which they are thoroughly sensible, whilst at the same time they recognise in them a satisfactory proof

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proof of Mr. Wade's purpose to act justly and uprightly, and to give weight to the maintenance of friendly relations. They take the opportunity afforded by this acknowledgment to express their thanks for his kindness, and they earnestly trust that any further intelligence relating to the same affair that may reach Mr. Wade may be communicated to them from time to time.
They avail &c.
J.B. 13⅝ yr., 4⅝ m., 7⅝ day.

Trans. by
(Signed) W. F. Mayers.

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Memorandum

Enclosure
No 6
in Mr. Lowdes
No 44
of June 10th 1874

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Memorandum by Mr Wade for H.I. the Prince of Kung and Ministers of the Yamen.

Peking. May 30th 1874.

Under date of the 12th May H.M.'s Consul at Tai wan Fu reports that on the 9th inst. he visited Lang Kiao Bay in H.M.'s Gunvessel "Hornet". A Japanese steamer, the "Nepaul", was found at anchor there, and on landing Mr. Gregory found a Japanese camp in course of being established. Some artillery had been landed. Three foreigners were on the spot. A visit was paid with the Commander of the gunvessel to the nearest Chinese village, called Ch'a-sia 茶社. The people shewed no alarm at the arrival

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of the Japanese, whom they rather welcomed as likely to afford them protection against their enemies the Mow-tan savages.

After leaving Lang Kiao in the morning of the 10th the gunvessel met a Japanese transport going in that direction, and another steamer was seen coming from the South. On reaching Taiwan Fu Mr. Gregory paid a visit to the Taotai, who stated that he was without instructions or advices from his superiors about the Japanese expedition.

A despatch has also been received under date of the 13th inst. from Sir Harry Parkes, who informs Mr. Wade that the Formosan expedition, said to have been postponed, has left

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left Nagasaki, but without its commander. The Minister of Foreign Affairs has stated to 300 Sir Harry Parkes that the departure of the ships is merely a preliminary step, and that they are to rendezvous at Amoy, where they will be joined by their commander, who will come to an understanding with the Chinese authorities before proceeding to Formosa. A telegram of the 12th inst. from Amoy informs Sir H. Parkes that "last evening 2 Japanese men-of-war left Amoy for Formosa." General Legendre has staid behind, but two foreign officers have proceeded to Formosa. The Foreign Minister continues to assure Sir Harry Parkes that Japan has no

desire

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desire to provoke hostilities
with China.

(Signed) T. F. Wade.

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Translation

—a—

Prince of Hungs
to
Mr Wade

—a—

Enclosure
No 4
in Mr Wades
No 99
of June 10th 1874

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Peking. May 31st 1874.

A communication from the Prince of Kung to H.B.M. Ministers.

On the 29th inst. a decree was received to the following effect:

" We appoint Shên Pao-chêng as Imperial Commissioner for the administration of maritime defence in Tai-wan (Formosa) and the adjacent parts, and conjointly for the management of foreign affairs, in order to give weight to the duties and authority [appertaining to this position]."

This decree having been reverently received and reverently complied

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complied with, the Yamên of
Foreign Affairs have to observe
that, as regards Formosa and
the adjacent parts, when
questions affecting foreign
nationalities arise, the
Governor-General of Fukien and
Chekiang [to whom the manage-
ment of such questions would properly
belong] being in residence
at the provincial capital
(Foochow) is comparatively
remote from the spot; whereas
His Excellency the Director-
General of the Foochow Naval
Arsenal, Shên, who has long
been versed in the circumstances
of Chinese and foreign
[intercourse], having now
been

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been appointed by special decree
to the post abovenamed, will 302
beyond doubt be found capable
of elaborating measures with
thorough carefulness, and of
fulfilling to the utmost the
duties incumbent upon him
and the exercise of his authority.
By this means the provisions
of Treaties will be complied
with and due weight be
given to existing relations of
amity. It is the duty [of
the Prince of Kung] to bring
this to the knowledge of the
British Ministers.

Tung Che. 13th year, 4th mon, 16th day.

Translated by
(signed) W. F. Mayers
C.S.

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Mr. Lowder
to
Prince of Hung
—2—

Enclosure
No. 8
in Mr. Lowder's
No. 99
of June 18th 1874.

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Peking
2 June 1874

Sir

I have the honor to acknowledge Y. I. H.'s despatch of the 31st. May informing me of the appointment of H. E. Shen, late Director of the Arsenal at Foochow, to be Imperial Commissioner for the defence of Formosa and the administration of foreign affairs on that Island.

The Imperial Commissioner Shen's

I. H.
He Prince of Kung

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Shen's activity and ability have
long been known to me.
When reporting his appointment
to H. M. Government I shall
express a hope that his term of
office may be marked by an
improvement in the general
conditions of foreign trade in
Formosa and by development
of the vast resources of the
Island in which native and
foreigner are alike interested.

(?) J. F. Wade

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Sir L. Stockwell
to
Mr. Lowther

Enclosure
No 4
in Mr. Lowther's
No 99
of June 10th 1874

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'Cadmus' at Shanghai
12. May. 1874.

Sir,

I have the honour to acknowledge the receipt, on the 9th Instant, of Your Excellency's letter of the 20th April relative to the proposed Japanese expedition to the Island of Formosa.

Her Majesty's Consuls at Amoy and Foo-chow informed me on my recent visit to those ports

His Excellency
Thomas Francis Wade
&c &c &c
Peking

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that up to the present time the rumours of the intended action of the Japanese do not appear to have caused any excitement amongst the Chinese.

I note Your Excellency's wishes that the ports of Tai-oan and Tam sui, especially the former, should be taken under our protection as much as may be conveniently possible.

The "Hornet," Gun-vessel left Amoy on the 6th Instant under orders to visit the Pescadores, Taiwan, Ta Kao and (if necessary) Liang Kiao; and

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and to afford Her Majesty's Consul at Takao the opportunity of visiting Taiwan and Liang Kiao should he wish to do so.

The "Kestrel" Gun vessel stationed at Foochow will visit Tamsui periodically as usual. I also propose that the 'Thalia' now at Hong Kong and leaving about the end of this month for Japan, shall visit the Formosa Ports on her way up.

The "Dwarf" Gun vessel now at Nagasaki is held in readiness to proceed to South Formosa to watch

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watch proceedings, as soon as I receive positive intelligence that the expedition will proceed thither.

The latest information I have received is as follows:— On April 25th I was acquainted by telegraph that the Formosa expedition was postponed, pending negotiations with China. On the 27th the Japanese steamer 'Nepaul' left Nagasaki with troops and stores for Amoy, and it was reported that after remaining there two or three days she would proceed to South Formosa. On the 28th the Iron-clad "Stonewall" left

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left it is said for Nagosima. On the 4th Instant Captain Arthur of the "Iron Duke" telegraphed from Nagasaki, that two Japanese men of war and two steamers, with twelve hundred troops had left for Formosa; but I feel somewhat doubtful as to whether their destination was positively determined.

I propose to remain at Shanghai until the 26th Instant, and then to leave in the "Cadmus for Yokohama, via the Inland Sea.

I

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I have the honour to be,
Sir,
Your Excellency's
Most obedient humble Servant

(Signed) Charles Shadwell

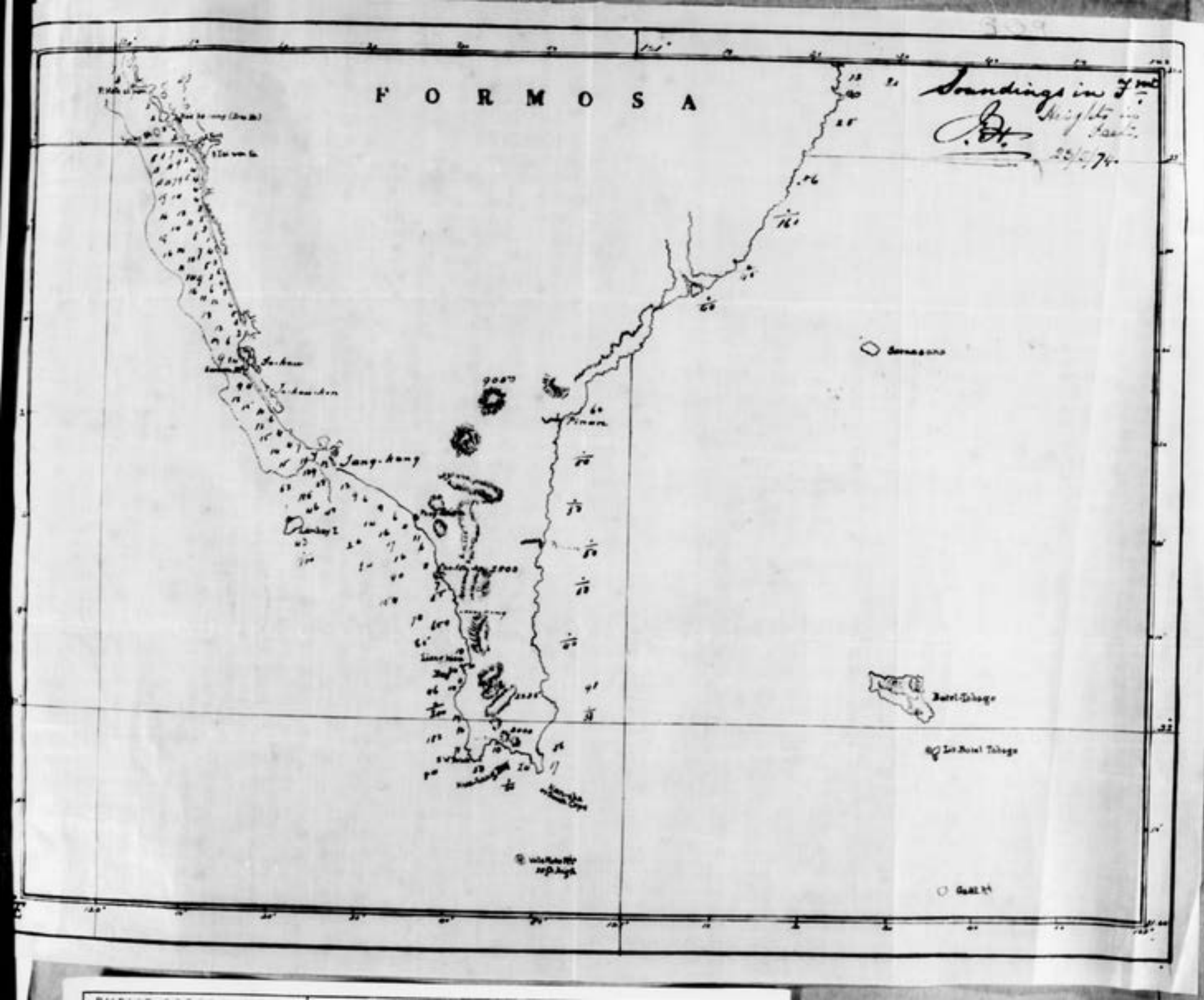
{ Vice Admiral and
Commander in Chief

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Map

print this inclosure

Inclosure
No 10
in Mr Wades
No 99
of June 10th 1874


FORMOSA
Soundings in Fms
Heights in Feet
Jang-hang
Botel-Tobago